

Will McGowan

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Graduate Recruitment Team
Goldman Sachs International
Plumtree Court, 25 Shoe Lane
London EC4A 4AU

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the 2027 EMEA London Investment Banking New Analyst Programme in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Goldman Sachs's role on Europe's largest deals this year, including advising Unilever on the sale of its food business to McCormick, is the kind of food and consumer work my agri-finance research has prepared me to understand.

My clearest preparation for banking has been taking transactions apart. As co-founder and Treasurer of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, the university's first agri-finance society, I grew membership to 126 and led weekly research sessions on deals such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC, explaining the strategic rationale, the deal structure and the valuation to members, including many from outside finance. My strongest academic results are in the same territory: 90% in first-year Finance and 78%, the second-highest mark, in a third-year group project for Advanced Corporate Finance and Financial Markets.

Investment banking appeals to me because every transaction is a chain of judgements about who should buy, why now and at what price, and each one has to survive scrutiny from clients and counterparties. The analyst's part in that chain is accuracy under deadline, a habit I have built outside the classroom. For nearly two years at KONG, I reconciled end-of-shift cash and card takings while studying full-time. I now run the drinks programme as Head Mixologist at Le Set, a new 200-cover Glasgow venue, where I wrote the batch specifications and trained around 15 bar staff to standards that have to hold when someone else executes them.

Goldman Sachs's EMEA M&A franchise stands out to me because the firm advised on 44% of the region's M&A by value in the first half of 2026, its largest share in nearly a decade, including advising Unilever on the roughly \$45 billion sale of its food business to McCormick. Food and agribusiness transactions are exactly what I have spent the past year dissecting with the Agricapital Society, and I would value learning how a deal of that scale is put together, from the strategic case to the separation of the business.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan